WELCOME TO THE

BRAZIL 2026

CUP OF EXCELLENCE®

WHERE SPECIALTY COFFEE
LEGENDS TAKE SHAPE

INTERNATIONAL JURY PROGRAM

October 24 – November 1, 2026

SÃO PAULO · VARGINHA · BRAZIL

Welcome to Brazil

We are delighted to welcome you to the international phase of the **Cup of Excellence Brazil 2026**, a celebration of the finest coffees in the country and of the passionate people who produce them.

Your week begins in **São Paulo** and soon takes you to **Southern Minas Gerais**, the heart of Brazilian specialty coffee. On the way, you will be hosted at **Coopervass**, in São Gonçalo do Sapucaí, before settling in **Varginha**, home of BSCA and one of Brazil's most important coffee hubs.

Over the following days you will calibrate, cup and select the best lots of the year at the **Centro de Excelência em Cafeicultura**, visit Fazenda Monte Alegre, share meals with the producers, cooperatives and exporters who make this competition possible, and close the journey at the **Awards Ceremony in São Paulo** on October 31.

Please do not hesitate to contact our team if you have any questions or special requests. Thank you for being part of this celebration of passion, tradition and excellence in coffee.

BSCA · Brazil Specialty Coffee Association

Your week at a glance

Oct 24 → 25	Transamerica Prime International Plaza · São Paulo
Oct 25 → 30	Grand Enio Hotel · Varginha, MG
Oct 30 → Nov 1	Marriott Executive Apartments · São Paulo

CUPPINGS

Oct 26 – 29 · Centro de Excelência em Cafeicultura, Varginha

AWARDS CEREMONY

Oct 31 · Bisutti, São Paulo

PROGRAM

Day by day

DAY 1

Saturday, October 24

Arrival in São Paulo

SÃO PAULO · SP

Throughout the day — Arrival at **São Paulo / Guarulhos International Airport (GRU)**
Transfer to the **Transamerica Prime International Plaza Hotel** · approx. 1 hour

12:30 – 3:00 PM — Lunch at the hotel, at your convenience

6:30 – 10:30 PM — Dinner at the hotel, at your convenience

DAY 2

Sunday, October 25

São Paulo → São Gonçalo do Sapucaí → Varginha

SUL DE MINAS · MG

6:30 AM — Breakfast available at the hotel

10:00 AM — Departure · transfer to **Coopervass**
São Gonçalo do Sapucaí, MG · approx. 5 hours by highway

4:00 PM — Happy hour sponsored by **Coopervass**
São Gonçalo do Sapucaí, MG

9:00 PM — Arrival in Varginha · check-in at the **Grand Enio Hotel**

DAY 3

Monday, October 26

Calibration Day

VARGINHA · MG

6:30 AM Breakfast available at the hotel

8:00 AM Departure · transfer to the cupping site
Travel time: 15 minutes

8:30 AM **Opening of activities**
by BSCA and the Head Judge

10:00 AM Cupping 1 · **Calibration**

11:30 AM Cupping 2 · **Calibration**

1:00 PM Brunch break

1:45 PM Cupping 3 · **Calibration**

3:30 PM End of the day

4:30 PM Departure for dinner sponsored by **Caxambu & Aracaçu** and **SMC Specialty Coffees**
A farm in Três Pontas, MG

9:00 PM Return from dinner

Cupping days: please avoid perfume, scented lotions and strong-smelling products during sessions, and keep hydrated. Water is available at the cupping site.

DAY

4

Tuesday, October 27

Round 1

VARGINHA · MG

6:30 AM	Breakfast available at the hotel
8:00 AM	Departure · transfer to the cupping site Travel time: 15 minutes
8:30 AM	Cupping 1 · **Round 1, Session 1**
10:00 AM	Cupping 2 · **Round 1, Session 2**
11:30 AM	Cupping 3 · **Round 1, Session 3**
1:00 PM	Brunch break
1:45 PM	Cupping 4 · **Round 1, Session 4**
3:30 PM	End of the day
5:30 PM	Departure for dinner sponsored by **NKG** NKG
9:00 PM	Return from dinner

DAY
5

Wednesday, October 28

Round 2

VARGINHA · MG

6:30 AM	Breakfast available at the hotel
8:00 AM	Departure · transfer to the cupping site Travel time: 15 minutes
8:30 AM	Cupping 1 · **Round 2, Session 1**
10:00 AM	Cupping 2 · **Round 2, Session 2**
11:30 AM	Cupping 3 · **Round 2, Session 3**
1:00 PM	Brunch break
1:45 PM	Cupping 4 · **Round 2, Session 4**
3:30 PM	End of the day
6:50 PM	Departure for dinner sponsored by **Sancoffee** Fogueira
9:00 PM	Return from dinner

DAY
6

Thursday, October 29

Top 3 Selection

VARGINHA · MG

6:30 AM Breakfast available at the hotel

7:30 AM Departure · transfer to the cupping site
Travel time: 15 minutes

8:00 AM Cupping 1 · **Top 3**

9:15 AM Cupping 2 · **Top 3**

10:30 AM Cupping 3 · **Top 3**

12:00 PM Lunch & tour · **Porto Seco**
Varginha's dry port, a customs hub for coffee leaving Brazil

4:00 PM End of the day

7:00 PM Departure for the **Minasul Party**
FLY Events

> We have been invited to the awards ceremony of the cooperative's coffee competition. It is a chance to meet the producers and experience a Brazilian specialty coffee cooperative from the inside.
>
> **DRESS CODE: SMART CASUAL**

9:00 PM Return



DAY 7

Friday, October 30

Farm Tour & Transfer to São Paulo

MONTE BELO · MG → SÃO PAULO · SP

6:30 AM — Breakfast available at the hotel

6:50 AM — Departure · transfer to the farm tour
Travel time: approx. 1h10

8:00 AM – 1:00 PM — **Farm tour & lunch** · Fazenda Monte Alegre
Monte Belo, MG

1:30 PM — Departure from Fazenda Monte Alegre · transfer to São Paulo
By highway

6:00 PM — Estimated arrival in São Paulo · check-in at the **Marriott Executive Apartments São Paulo**

7:00 PM — Departure for dinner sponsored by **Nucoffee**
Fazenda Churrascada

9:00 PM — Return from dinner

Check-out day: please check out of the Grand Enio Hotel and have your luggage ready before the 6:50 AM departure. Your bags travel with the group to São Paulo.

DAY
8

Saturday, October 31

Cup of Excellence Brazil 2026 Awards Ceremony

SÃO PAULO · SP

6:30 AM — Breakfast available at the hotel

9:00 AM — Departure · transfer to the COE Ceremony
Bisutti · São Paulo · 20 minutes

10:00 AM – 2:00 PM — **Cup of Excellence Brazil 2026 Awards Ceremony**

2:30 PM — Return to the hotel
End of the official agenda



DAY
9

Sunday, November 1

Departure Day

SÃO PAULO · SP

6:30 AM — Breakfast available at the hotel

Throughout the day — Hotel → Airport (GRU) transfers
According to each guest's flight schedule

FARM TOUR HOST · DAY 7

Fazenda Monte Alegre

Monte Alegre Coffees · Monte Belo, Southern Minas Gerais

Fazenda Monte Alegre was already a traditional, well-known coffee producer in Southern Minas Gerais when the **Vieira family** acquired it in **1917**. Beyond coffee, the family dedicated itself to sugar cane, corn and cattle.

In 1990, **Cia. Monte Alegre** was founded to run the family's land, and in 1991 it became one of the **founders of BSCA**. In 2007 the company adopted the **Monte Alegre Coffees** identity to focus on specialty coffee.

Since its founding, Monte Alegre has invested in protecting forests and water, using sustainable agricultural technologies, selected seedlings, selective harvesting, diverse processing methods and its own infrastructure.

Certifications & affiliations: Rainforest Alliance · Certifica Minas Café · CSC · BSCA · Cecafé · Cafés do Brasil

1917
in the Vieira family

1991
BSCA founding member

2007
Monte Alegre Coffees identity

2017
centenary year

CUPPING VENUE · OCT 26 – 30

Centro de Excelência em Cafeicultura

SENAR · Varginha, MG

All cupping sessions of the international phase take place at the **Centro de Excelência em Cafeicultura** of the CNA/SENAR System in Varginha, a 5,100 m² training centre with laboratories for coffee grading, roasting, grinding and cupping.

1. Save the access image below on your phone before Monday.
2. At the entrance, present the QR Code at the **gate or turnstile face reader**.
3. Valid from October 26 to 30. Keep your screen brightness up when scanning.



GOOD TO KNOW

General information

AIRPORT OF ARRIVAL

São Paulo / Guarulhos International Airport (**GRU**), Guarulhos · SP. Our transfer team will meet you on arrival.

ACCOMMODATION

Oct 24 → 25
Transamerica Prime International Plaza Hotel · São Paulo

Oct 25 → 30
Grand Enio Hotel · Varginha, MG

Oct 30 → Nov 1
Marriott Executive Apartments São Paulo

TRANSPORTATION

BSCA coordinates all your transfers: airport to hotel, São Paulo to Southern Minas Gerais, daily trips to the cupping site, dinners, the farm tour, the return to São Paulo and your departure to GRU.

MEALS

BSCA and its sponsors provide meals for judges and observers throughout the official program. Please tell us in advance about any **dietary restrictions or allergies**.

DRESS CODE

Feel free to show us your personal style. The Awards Ceremony dress code is **casual**; for the Minasul Party (Day 6) it is **smart casual**. Pack spring clothing, a light jacket for the evenings, comfortable closed shoes for the farm tour, sunscreen, mosquito repellent and a small umbrella.

WEATHER

Late October is spring and the start of the rainy season: warm days, mild nights and possible afternoon showers.

Varginha	São Paulo
16–28 °C · 61–82 °F	16–26 °C · 61–79 °F

MONEY & PAYMENTS

The currency is the **Brazilian Real (R$ · BRL)**. Credit cards and contactless payments are widely accepted; carry a little cash for small purchases. Restaurants usually add an optional **10% service charge**. Bank transfer instructions for advance payments are available on request.

TIME ZONE & LANGUAGE

Brasília Time, **UTC−3** (no daylight saving). The official language is **Portuguese**; English is spoken at hotels, and a translation app is handy elsewhere.

PHONE & CONNECTIVITY

Country code **+55**. Area codes: **11** São Paulo, **35** Southern Minas Gerais. Hotels offer Wi-Fi; a roaming plan or eSIM is recommended for the road trips. WhatsApp is the most common way to communicate in Brazil.

SAFETY

Keep valuables out of sight in busy areas, prefer hotel or app-booked rides and stay with the group on transfers. If anything happens, contact the BSCA team right away.

HEALTH

Drink bottled or filtered water, use sunscreen and repellent, and keep hydrated during cupping days. Bring personal medication in your carry-on. Travel health insurance is strongly recommended.

EMERGENCY NUMBERS IN BRAZIL

190 Police

192 Ambulance (SAMU)

193 Fire department

Free calls from any phone, 24 hours a day.

ELECTRICITY IN BRAZIL

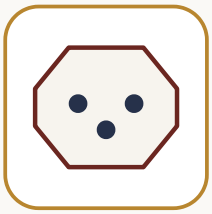
Plugs & voltage

Brazil uses its own plug standard and two different voltages. Please check your devices before plugging them in.

127 V
Standard voltage in São Paulo and Varginha

220 V
Also found in some outlets and cities · check the label

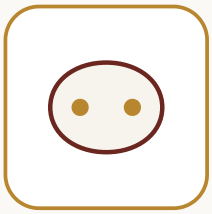
60 Hz
Frequency nationwide



TYPE N

Brazilian standard

Three round pins: two power pins and a ground pin in the middle. Most outlets are the **10 A** version (4.0 mm pins).



TYPE C

Europlug

Two-pin European plugs **fit Type N 10 A outlets** without an adapter.

BEFORE YOU PLUG IN

- Check your charger label: **"INPUT 100–240 V ~ 50/60 Hz"** means it works anywhere in Brazil. Most phone, laptop and camera chargers are dual voltage.
- Single-voltage devices (hair dryers, straighteners, some shavers) need a **voltage converter**. A 110 V-only device plugged into 220 V can be damaged.
- Plugs from the **US/Canada (A/B), UK (G), Australia (I)** and most of Asia need a **travel adapter**. A universal adapter is the safest choice.
- Outlets are often labelled **127 V** or **220 V**. If in doubt, ask the hotel front desk; many hotels lend adapters.

CONTACTS & SUPPORT

Main contact in Brazil

Our team is available throughout the program for any question, flight change, dietary need or emergency.

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BSCA QUALITY DEPARTMENT

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BSCA HEADQUARTERS

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WEBSITE & SOCIAL

bsca.com.br

@bsca_specialtycoffee

EMERGENCY

190 Police · **192** Ambulance · **193** Fire

Thank you to our hosts

Coopervass
Happy hour · Day 2

Caxambu & Aracaçu
Dinner · Day 3

SMC Specialty Coffees
Dinner · Day 3

NKG
Dinner · Day 4

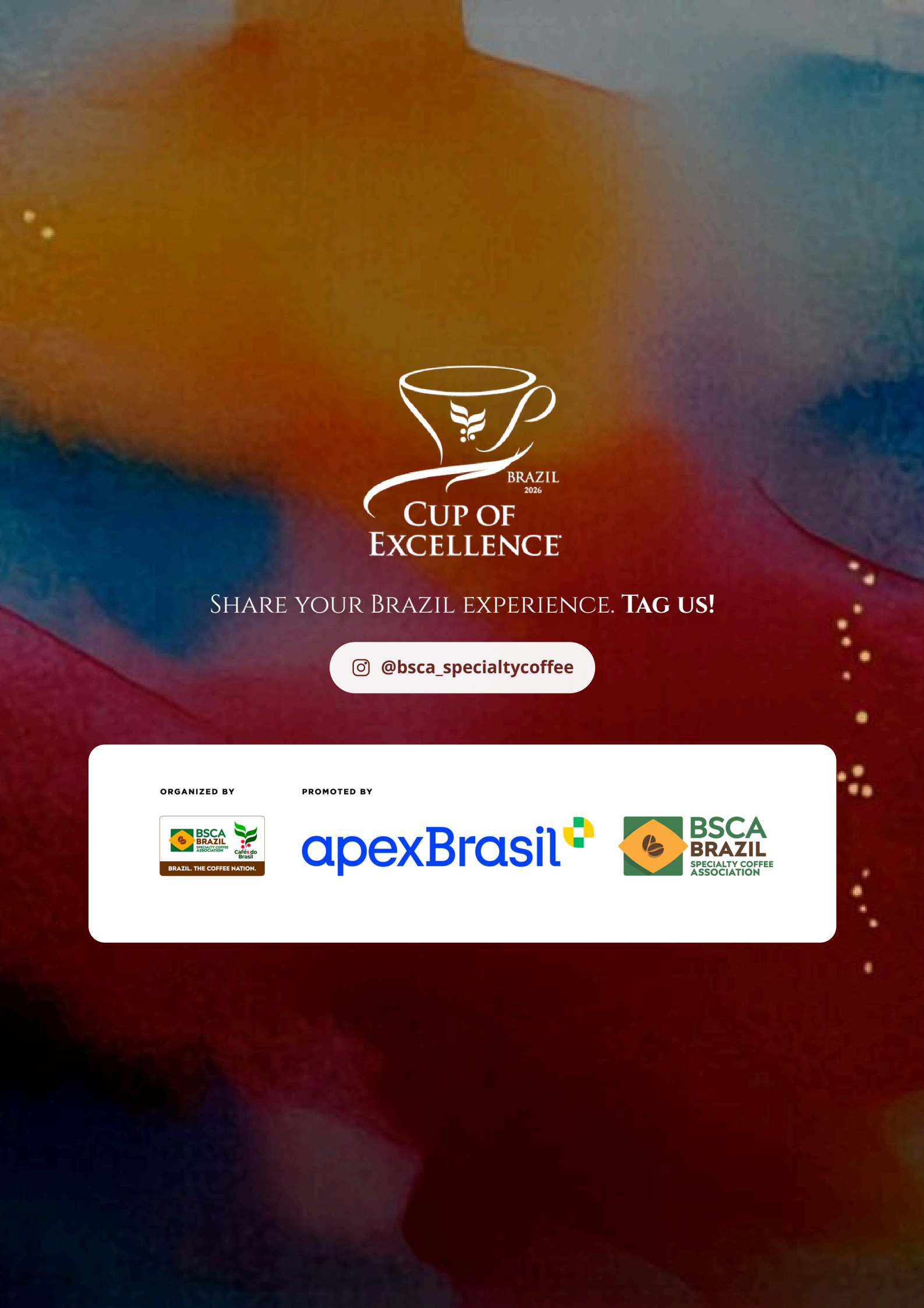
Sancoffee
Dinner · Day 5

Porto Seco
Lunch & tour · Day 6

Minasul
Minasul Party · Day 6

Fazenda Monte Alegre
Farm tour & lunch · Day 7

Nucoffee
Dinner · Day 7



SHARE YOUR BRAZIL EXPERIENCE. **TAG US!**

@bsca_specialtycoffee

ORGANIZED BY

BSCA BRAZIL SPECIALTY COFFEE ASSOCIATION
Café do Brasil
BRAZIL. THE COFFEE NATION.

PROMOTED BY

apexBrasil

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